KalSea: Closing the Loop on Diffusion Transformer Caching with Kalman Gap Smoothing

Anonymous CVPR submission



Figure 1. **Generated by our cache.** Each tile is a FLUX.1-dev image (1024×1024, 50 steps) generated with KalSea at $\delta = 0.2$, i.e. 27 of 50 transformer evaluations (1.85× fewer); the tiles are only downscaled, and the billboard is the central 2:1 band of its image. Prompts and seeds: supplement.

Abstract

Diffusion transformers spend most of their sampling time in the block stack, which runs at each of tens of sampling steps. Training-free caches skip it on some steps: a gate decides when *to compute, and a filler decides* what *to write on the skipped steps, typically the last block-stack residual or a forecast of it. Both fillers are open loop: when the next computed step reveals how wrong the filler was, its error has already been integrated into the latent and is never corrected. We close this loop with predictor-corrector gap smoothing (PCGS). Behind the spectrally aligned gate of SeaCache, a damped-trend Kalman filter forecasts the block-stack residual on skipped steps. When the next step is computed, a Rauch–Tung–Striebel smoother turns the filter's innovation into corrected residuals for the whole skipped gap, which we re-integrate through the output layers only before sampling continues from the corrected latent. PCGS requires no additional transformer evaluations. On FLUX.1-dev and held-out DrawBench prompts, our cache reaches a PSNR of 27.72 dB with respect to the 50-step sampler at 18.1 of 50 transformer evaluations, against 26.29 dB reported for SeaCache at 18.4, and 22.53 against 21.33 dB at 13 evaluations. In paired comparisons, PCGS alone contributes 0.81 dB (95% CI [0.63, 1.00]) and 0.61 dB [0.48, 0.76], and it also improves plain reuse and linear extrapolation. On HunyuanVideo and Wan2.1 at SeaCache's budgets, it improves PSNR over SeaCache run in the same setup by 1.9–3.2 dB and 0.3–2.3 dB.*

1. Introduction

Diffusion and flow-matching transformers [8, 33] generate high-resolution images and videos [3, 17, 47], but sampling is slow: each of tens of steps runs dozens of transformer blocks over thousands of tokens. Training-free caching exploits the similarity of consecutive steps [21, 30, 42]: on some steps the block stack is skipped and its output is approximated from the computed steps. A cache thus makes two decisions: *when* to compute, and *what* to write on the steps it skips.

Most work has focused on the first decision. Adaptive gates accumulate a cheap proxy of the change of the network output and recompute once it exceeds a threshold [4, 21, 31]; SeaCache [7] measures this change after a spectral-evolution-

aware (SEA) filter that suppresses the noise component of the features. For the second decision, most caches reuse the last computed output [7, 21, 30, 42], while forecasting methods extrapolate it from several computed steps with Taylor expansions [22], Hermite or Chebyshev polynomials [9, 11], multistep formulas [54], or Kalman filters [35].

Reuse and forecasting share a structural limitation: they are *open loop*. The filler predicts the skipped steps from the past alone, and the sampler integrates its errors into the latent. These errors grow with the distance to the last computed step: on six reference trajectories of our development set, the relative error of the velocity obtained from a Kalman forecast of the residual grows from 4–5% at the first skipped step to over 20% at the seventh (supplement). When the next step is computed, its block-stack output reveals how wrong the forecast was, but existing caches use this observation only to predict the *next* gap; the latent, already advanced along erroneous velocities, is never revisited. Forecasting reduces this drift but does not remove it: as gaps grow, its advantage over reuse vanishes (Sec. 4.2).

We close the loop without evaluating the network again. Our key observation is that a skipped gap is a *smoothing* problem. With a Kalman filter as the predictor of the block-stack residual, the innovation at the next computed step b, *i.e.*, the observed minus the forecast residual, and the covariances accumulated over the gap determine, through the Rauch–Tung–Striebel (RTS) smoother [36], the minimum-mean-square-error residuals of all skipped steps under the filter's model. Because only the cheap output layers depend on the residual, we re-integrate the gap through them and continue sampling from the corrected latent. We call this procedure *predictor-corrector gap smoothing* (PCGS, Fig. 2). Like the corrector of UniPC [52], it reuses a network evaluation that the sampler performs anyway; unlike it, it corrects an entire gap of steps whose network outputs were never computed.

Combined with the unchanged SEA gate of SeaCache and a damped-trend Kalman forecaster of the block-stack residual, PCGS yields a training-free cache that changes neither the network, nor the sampler, nor the number of transformer evaluations. Our contributions are:

- We identify the open-loop nature of caching fillers: errors made on skipped steps are integrated into the latent and never corrected, and forecasting loses its advantage over reuse as gaps grow.
- We propose PCGS, which casts each skipped gap as a smoothing problem: once the next step is computed, the RTS smoother of the forecaster's own state-space model gives the residuals of the gap, which is re-integrated with the output layers only. We give the smoother gain in closed form for the damped-trend model under the irregular observations of an adaptive gate. PCGS adds neither transformer evaluations nor hyperparameters.
- On FLUX.1-dev and held-out DrawBench prompts [37], our cache reaches 27.72 dB PSNR with respect to the 50-step sampler at 18.1 of 50 evaluations, against 26.29 dB published for SeaCache at 18.4, and 22.53 against 21.33 dB at 13. Against our re-run of SeaCache in the same setup, the paired gains are 2.39 dB [2.03, 2.75] and 1.27 dB [1.02, 1.52], of which PCGS contributes 0.81 and 0.61 dB. PCGS improves on the predictor at every budget from 9 to 27 evaluations and also improves reuse and linear extrapolation; its gain comes from re-integrating the gap rather than from the exact form of the smoother gains. On HunyuanVideo it improves on SeaCache in the same setup by 3.17 and 1.92 dB at 24 and 16 evaluations; on Wan2.1 it exceeds the published results by 5.07 and 2.07 dB at 24 and 17 evaluations.

Code will be released.

2. Related Work

Training-free caching. Caching exploits the similarity of network activations at consecutive sampling steps. DeepCache [30] and block caching [50] reuse features of U-Nets; Δ-DiT [5], FORA [42] and ToCa [55] bring reuse to diffusion transformers at the level of blocks, attention and MLP outputs, and tokens; PAB [53] and FasterCache [28] target video models, OmniCache [6] distributes reuse over the sampling trajectory, and Learning-to-Cache [29] learns which layers to cache. Recent caches decide online: AdaCache [14] adapts the schedule to each video, TeaCache [21] accumulates the relative change of the timestep-modulated input of the first block and recomputes once it exceeds a threshold, MagCache [31] models the magnitude ratio of successive residuals, and DiCache [4] probes a shallow layer. SeaCache [7] keeps TeaCache's accumulate-and-reset rule but measures the change after a spectral-evolution-aware filter derived from the optimal linear denoiser, so that the gate responds to content rather than noise. We adopt the SEA gate unchanged and change what is written on the steps it skips.

Forecasting and correcting cached features. TaylorSeer [22] replaces reuse by a Taylor extrapolation from finite differences of cached features, HiCache [9] uses scaled Hermite polynomials, Spectrum [11] fits Chebyshev polynomials by ridge regression, and FoCa [54] combines a BDF2 predictor with a Heun-type calibration. Other methods check or repair what is written on skipped steps: SpeCa [23] accepts or rejects each forecast with a lightweight verification, OmniCache [6] filters the noise introduced by reused features, ERTACache [34] adjusts integration intervals and rectifies cache-induced errors with a closed-form model profiled offline, and GP-Refiner [43] regresses the deviation of forecast features online with a Gaussian process. All of them improve the value used at the *current or upcoming*

steps; none revises the latent of steps that have already been skipped. PCGS is complementary: it leaves the forecast for upcoming steps unchanged and corrects the past gap. Contemporaneous with our work, SpecKCast [35] tracks the DCT coefficients of the model output with damped-trend Kalman filters along band-specific warped time and schedules computation by the filter's uncertainty. Our predictor uses the same state-space model, but for the block-stack residual behind the SEA gate, where the frequency decomposition is unnecessary (Sec. 4.4). SpecKCast uses the filter only as a predictor; PCGS adds the smoother and the latent correction, which also improve reuse and linear extrapolation.

Filtering, smoothing and predictor-corrector integration. The Kalman filter [15] and the RTS smoother [36] are the exact recursive estimators of linear-Gaussian state-space models [39]. Our forecaster uses the integrated Wiener process (constant-velocity) model of target tracking [2] with a damped trend [10] and adapts its process noise from the innovations [32]. Probabilistic ODE solvers infer the solution of an ODE from evaluations of its vector field by Gauss–Markov filtering and smoothing [41, 48]; we instead use smoothing to infer the network evaluations that a cache skipped. In diffusion sampling, score-based SDE samplers alternate a numerical predictor with Langevin corrector steps [45], Heun's method corrects an Euler step with a second evaluation [16], and UniPC [52] raises the accuracy of multistep solvers such as DPM-Solver++ [26] with a corrector that reuses the next model evaluation. PCGS shares UniPC's principle of a corrector without extra evaluations, but corrects a whole gap of skipped steps.

Other acceleration. Fast ODE solvers [16, 25, 26, 44, 52] reduce the number of steps, distillation [27, 38, 40, 46] trains few-step students, and quantization [18] lowers the cost of each step. These directions are orthogonal to caching, which keeps the weights and the sampler unchanged.

3. Method

We keep the SEA gate of SeaCache and change what is written on skipped steps (Fig. 2). We review flow-matching sampling, residual caching and the gate (Sec. 3.1), then describe the Kalman predictor (Sec. 3.2), the corrector PCGS (Sec. 3.3) and the cost (Sec. 3.4).

3.1. Preliminaries

Flow-matching sampling. Rectified-flow models [1, 8, 20, 24] interpolate $\mathbf{x}_\sigma = (1-\sigma)\mathbf{x}^\star + \sigma\boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ between data $\mathbf{x}^\star$ and Gaussian noise $\boldsymbol{\epsilon}$, and learn the velocity $\boldsymbol{\epsilon} - \mathbf{x}^\star$. Sampling integrates the learned velocity over a decreasing schedule $\sigma_0 > \sigma_1 > \cdots > \sigma_N = 0$ with Euler steps,

$$\mathbf{x}_{i+1} = \mathbf{x}_i + (\sigma_{i+1} - \sigma_i)\,\mathbf{v}_i, \qquad i = 0, \ldots, N-1. \quad (1)$$

Residual caching. A diffusion transformer computes the velocity in three stages,

$$\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}} = \text{Emb}(\mathbf{x}_i), \quad \mathbf{h}_i^{\text{out}} = \mathcal{F}(\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}}), \quad \mathbf{v}_i = \text{Out}(\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{out}}, \mathbf{c}_i), \quad (2)$$

where Emb embeds the latent patches, $\mathcal{F}$ is the block stack (in FLUX.1-dev, 19 double-stream and 38 single-stream blocks, which also process the text tokens), Out is the final adaptive normalization and linear projection, and $\mathbf{c}_i$ embeds the timestep and the guidance scale. Almost all computation is in $\mathcal{F}$. Residual caches [7, 21] store the block-stack residual of the image tokens, $\mathbf{r}_i = \mathbf{h}_i^{\text{out}} - \mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}}$, on computed steps. On skipped steps they run only Emb and Out, with $\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{out}} = \mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}} + \hat{\mathbf{r}}_i$, where the filler $\hat{\mathbf{r}}_i$ is the last computed residual (reuse) or a forecast.

The SEA gate. TeaCache [21] and SeaCache [7] decide whether to compute from the timestep-modulated input of the first block, $\mathbf{I}_i$, *i.e.*, its adaptive layer normalization applied to $\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}}$. SeaCache filters $\mathbf{I}_i$ on the token grid with the normalized gain of the optimal linear denoiser under a power-law spectrum, $G_i(f) \propto a_i S(f)/(a_i^2 S(f) + b_i^2)$ with $S(f) = |f|^{-\beta}$, $a_i = 1 - \sigma_i$ and $b_i = \sigma_i$, and accumulates the relative ℓ_1 change of the filtered input,

$$d_i = \frac{\|\,\text{SEA}_i(\mathbf{I}_i) - \text{SEA}_{i-1}(\mathbf{I}_{i-1})\|_1}{\|\,\text{SEA}_{i-1}(\mathbf{I}_{i-1})\|_1}, \quad D_i = D_{i-1} + d_i. \quad (3)$$

Step i is computed if $D_i \geq \delta$, after which D_i is reset to zero, or if it is the first or the last step; otherwise it is skipped. The threshold δ sets the budget. We use the official gate unchanged ($\beta = 2$ for images and 3 for videos).

3.2. Kalman residual forecasting (predictor)

The residual evolves smoothly but nonlinearly along the trajectory, and the cache observes it only at the irregular steps chosen by the gate. Following the state-space model of the contemporaneous SpecKCast [35], which forecasts the model output, we model every element of the residual as a damped trend observed in noise. The state $\mathbf{s}_i = [m_i, \nu_i]^\top$ holds a value and its rate of change with respect to a time coordinate s that increases monotonically along the schedule, with steps $\Delta s_i = s(i) - s(i-1)$. At every step, computed or skipped, the filter predicts

$$\mathbf{s}_i^- = \mathbf{A}_i\,\mathbf{s}_{i-1}^+, \qquad \mathbf{P}_i^- = \mathbf{A}_i\,\mathbf{P}_{i-1}^+\mathbf{A}_i^\top + \mathbf{Q}_i, \quad (4)$$

$$\mathbf{A}_i = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \Delta s_i \\ 0 & \rho_i \end{bmatrix}, \qquad \mathbf{Q}_i = q\kappa \begin{bmatrix} \Delta s_i^3/3 & \Delta s_i^2/2 \\ \Delta s_i^2/2 & \Delta s_i \end{bmatrix},$$

with $\rho_i = e^{-\Delta s_i/\tau}$. Here $\mathbf{Q}_i$ is the process noise of an integrated Wiener process [2] with intensity $q\kappa$, and ρ_i

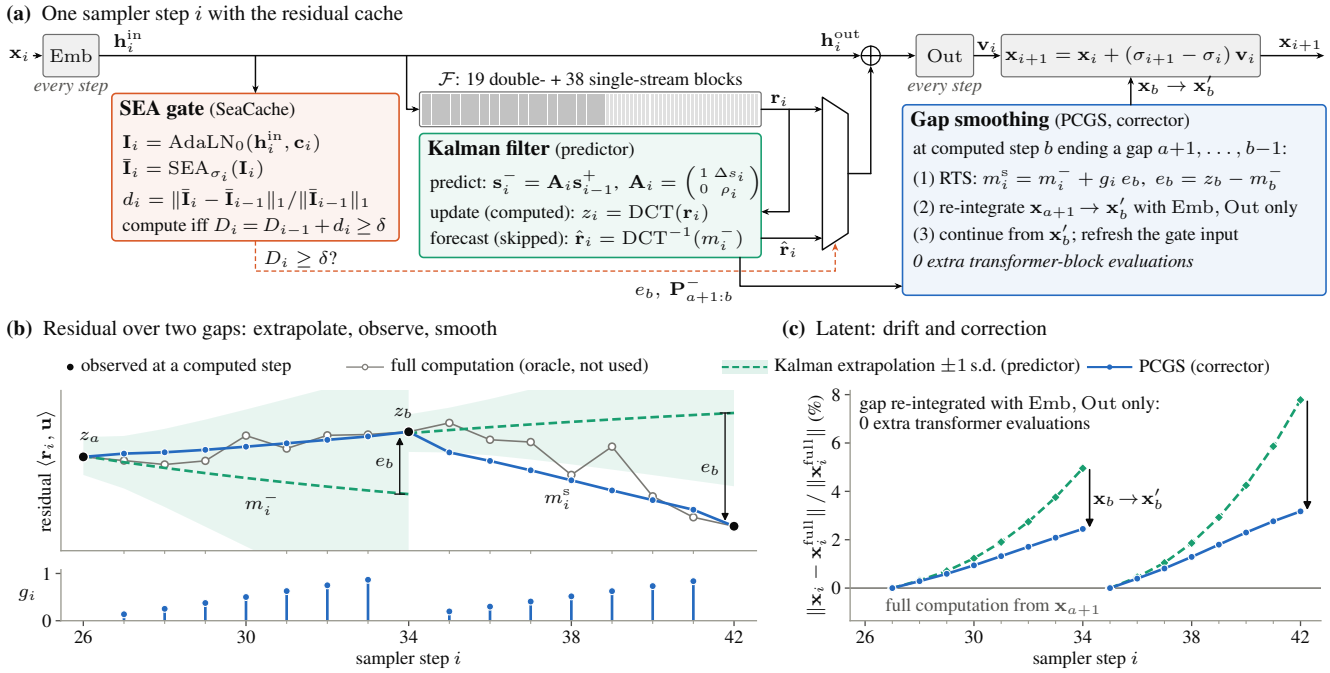


Figure 2. **Overview. (a)** In each step i, the SEA gate of SeaCache accumulates the SEA-filtered relative change d_i of the first block's modulated input and runs the blocks $\mathcal{F}$ only when the sum reaches δ; the residual $\mathbf{r}_i$ of a computed step updates a damped-trend Kalman filter per DCT coefficient (the predictor), whose forecast $\hat{\mathbf{r}}_i$ replaces it on skipped steps; Emb and Out run at every step. **(b)** When a computed step b ends the gap $a{+}1, \ldots, b{-}1$, PCGS spreads the innovation e_b over the gap with the RTS gains g_i, which grow toward b; the smoothed residuals m_i^{s} replace the extrapolation m_i^-. **(c)** Re-integrating the gap from $\mathbf{x}_{a+1}$ with Emb and Out only lowers the latent deviation from full computation at b by 25–59% in all ten gaps of this sample (here $5.0\% \to 2.4\%$ and $7.8\% \to 3.2\%$), without extra transformer evaluations. (b, c): one FLUX.1-dev generation at $\delta = 0.6$ for the DrawBench prompt whose PSNR gains (forecast over reuse, and gap smoothing over the forecast) are closest to the benchmark means ("McDonalds Church."); residual projected onto a fixed random unit direction $\mathbf{u}$ in the lowest DCT band (89% of its energy); gray: full computation, evaluated only for this figure.

damps the trend so that forecasts over long gaps do not overshoot [10]. On a computed step b the filter observes the residual element z_b with noise variance R and updates, with $\mathbf{h} = [1, 0]^\top$,

$$e_b = z_b - m_b^-, \quad S_b = [\mathbf{P}_b^-]_{00} + R, \quad \mathbf{k}_b = \mathbf{P}_b^- \mathbf{h} / S_b,$$
$$\mathbf{s}_b^+ = \mathbf{s}_b^- + \mathbf{k}_b\, e_b, \qquad \mathbf{P}_b^+ = (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{k}_b \mathbf{h}^\top)\, \mathbf{P}_b^-. \tag{5}$$

On skipped steps the moments are not updated ($\mathbf{s}_i^+ = \mathbf{s}_i^-$, $\mathbf{P}_i^+ = \mathbf{P}_i^-$), and the cache writes the predicted value, $\hat{\mathbf{r}}_i = m_i^-$, into $\mathbf{h}_i^{\mathrm{out}} = \mathbf{h}_i^{\mathrm{in}} + \hat{\mathbf{r}}_i$; the output layers run as usual. The intensity κ is adapted online so that the mean squared innovation matches its predicted variance S_b [32]: $\kappa \leftarrow \mathrm{clip}_{[0.1,10]}(\kappa\, \gamma_b^{0.2})$, where γ_b is the ratio of the two, clipped to $[0.1, 10]$.

Parametrizations. The covariance $\mathbf{P}$ is shared by all elements (per-element variant) or by all coefficients of a frequency band (DCT variant), so the filter costs a few element-wise operations per step and its gains are scalars per band. In the *per-element* variant, s is a warped log signal-to-noise ratio of the schedule. In the *DCT* variant, which follows SpecKCast and is our default for FLUX.1-dev, the residual of each channel is transformed with an orthonormal 2D DCT on the token grid, the coefficients are grouped into seven radial frequency bands, and each band has its own warped time coordinate and covariance. Values are normalized by the residual power of their band. The process-noise intensities, the initial trend variances and the band powers are calibrated once per model from 16 uncached trajectories whose prompts are disjoint from all evaluation prompts, and we use $\tau = 0.5$ and $R = 10^{-3}$ throughout (details in the supplement). The two variants perform the same (Sec. 4.4). With the corrector of Sec. 3.3, this predictor forms our full method, KalSea; the predictor alone (the SEA gate with Kalman residual forecasting) is labeled KalSea w/o PCGS in tables and figures.

3.3. Predictor-corrector gap smoothing (corrector)

Let $a < b$ be consecutive computed steps, so that $a{+}1, \ldots, b{-}1$ is a gap of skipped steps. The predictor has written $\hat{\mathbf{r}}_i = m_i^-$ on the gap, and the sampler has advanced the latent from $\mathbf{x}_{a+1}$ to $\mathbf{x}_b$ with the corresponding velocities. At step b the block stack runs and the filter observes z_b. The

innovation e_b is the forecast error at the end of the gap; the forecast errors inside the gap are correlated with it, since they stem from the same trend error and process noise. PCGS exploits this correlation in four steps.

(1) Smoothing. No observation falls inside the gap, so $\mathbf{s}_b = \mathbf{\Phi}(b,i)\,\mathbf{s}_i + \mathbf{w}_{i\to b}$ for $a < i < b$, with the transition $\mathbf{\Phi}(b,i) = \mathbf{A}_b\mathbf{A}_{b-1}\cdots\mathbf{A}_{i+1}$ and accumulated process noise $\mathbf{w}_{i\to b}$ independent of $\mathbf{s}_i$. Given the observations up to step a, the cross-covariance of $\mathbf{s}_i$ and z_b is therefore $\mathbf{P}_i^-\mathbf{\Phi}(b,i)^\top\mathbf{h}$, and conditioning the joint Gaussian on z_b yields

$$m_i^{\mathrm{s}} = m_i^- + g_i\,e_b, \qquad g_i = \frac{\left[\mathbf{P}_i^-\,\mathbf{\Phi}(b,i)^\top\right]_{00}}{[\mathbf{P}_b^-]_{00} + R}. \tag{6}$$

This is the RTS smoother [36] over $[a,b]$: inside the gap the filtered and predicted moments coincide, so the products of the smoother gains $\mathbf{P}_i^+\mathbf{A}_{i+1}^\top(\mathbf{P}_{i+1}^-)^{-1}$ telescope into $\mathbf{P}_i^-\mathbf{\Phi}(b,i)^\top(\mathbf{P}_b^-)^{-1}$ (proof in the supplement). The gains use only quantities that the filter already maintains, so the smoother has no parameters of its own. They increase across the gap: the steps closest to b, whose forecasts were the least reliable, absorb most of the innovation. In residual space, the smoothed residual is the forecast plus a gain-weighted share of the forecast error revealed at b,

$$\tilde{\mathbf{r}}_i = \hat{\mathbf{r}}_i + \mathcal{G}_i\big(\mathbf{r}_b - \hat{\mathbf{r}}_b\big), \qquad a < i < b, \tag{7}$$

where $\hat{\mathbf{r}}_b = m_b^-$ is the forecast for step b, and $\mathcal{G}_i$ multiplies by the scalar g_i (per-element variant) or applies the band gains $g_{i,\ell}$ in the DCT domain.

(2) Re-integration. Only the output layers depend on the residual. We therefore replay the sampler over the gap with the smoothed residuals, starting from the latent that the sampler actually used at the first skipped step, $\mathbf{x}'_{a+1} = \mathbf{x}_{a+1}$; for $a < i < b$,

$$\mathbf{x}'_{i+1} = \mathbf{x}'_i + (\sigma_{i+1} - \sigma_i)\ \mathrm{Out}\left(\mathrm{Emb}(\mathbf{x}'_i) + \tilde{\mathbf{r}}_i, \mathbf{c}_i\right). \tag{8}$$

Re-embedding the corrected latents $\mathbf{x}'_i$, instead of reusing the stored inputs $\mathbf{h}_i^{\mathrm{in}}$, makes the replay an exact Euler integration with the smoothed residuals; a batched variant that reuses $\mathbf{h}_i^{\mathrm{in}}$ is ablated in Sec. 4.4.

(3) Continuation. The block stack at step b was evaluated on the uncorrected latent $\mathbf{x}_b$. Instead of evaluating it again, we keep its residual $\mathbf{r}_b$, attach it to the corrected input, and absorb the latent correction into the velocity returned to the sampler:

$$\mathbf{v}'_b = \mathrm{Out}\left(\mathrm{Emb}(\mathbf{x}'_b) + \mathbf{r}_b, \mathbf{c}_b\right) + \frac{\mathbf{x}'_b - \mathbf{x}_b}{\sigma_{b+1} - \sigma_b}. \tag{9}$$

The unmodified Euler step (1) then produces $\mathbf{x}_{b+1} = \mathbf{x}'_b + (\sigma_{b+1} - \sigma_b)\ \mathrm{Out}(\mathrm{Emb}(\mathbf{x}'_b) + \mathbf{r}_b, \mathbf{c}_b)$, *i.e.*, sampling continues from $\mathbf{x}'_b$, and PCGS remains a drop-in replacement of the network output.

(4) Gate refresh. We recompute the gate's reference input of step b from $\mathbf{x}'_b$ (one adaptive normalization and one SEA filter), so that the gate follows the corrected trajectory; this detail has no measurable effect (Sec. 4.4).

Why smoothing corrects the latent. To first order, the latent error at step b is a linear function of the residual errors in the gap, each scaled by its step size and propagated by Jacobians of Emb and Out. Substituting conditional means into a linear function minimizes its expected squared error, so, under the filter's model and to first order, re-integrating with the smoothed residuals minimizes the expected squared error of $\mathbf{x}'_b$ given the observations up to step b; the forecasts are optimal only given those up to step a.

Remarks. PCGS does not change the predictor for the next gap, because smoothed and filtered estimates coincide at the latest observation. It only requires the solver update to be linear in the network output: for a multistep solver such as the UniPC sampler [52] of Wan2.1, the solver state is restored at step $a{+}1$ and the updates are replayed with the corrected outputs; with classifier-free guidance [12], the conditional and unconditional residuals are filtered and smoothed separately under a shared gate. For plain reuse, the smoother of the corresponding random-walk model with noise-free observations is the linear interpolation between $\mathbf{r}_a$ and $\mathbf{r}_b$. Algorithm 1 summarizes the procedure.

3.4. Cost

KalSea performs exactly the block-stack evaluations of the gate's schedule; PCGS adds none. It adds one evaluation of Emb and Out per skipped step and, at each computed step that closes a gap, one more of each plus the gate refresh. For FLUX.1-dev at 1024^2, Emb and Out are linear maps between 64 and 3072 channels over 4096 tokens, about 3.4 GFLOP per skipped step, whereas one transformer evaluation costs 59.5 TFLOPs (2976 for 50 steps [7]); over an image, PCGS costs about 0.3% of one transformer evaluation. The filter state and the gap buffer raise the peak memory by 0.16 GiB over the uncached sampler (SeaCache: 0.05 GiB; KalSea w/o PCGS: 0.14 GiB).

4. Experiments

4.1. Setup

Models and protocol. We follow the protocol of SeaCache [7]. For text-to-image generation we use FLUX.1-dev [3] at 1024×1024 with 50 Euler steps of its default

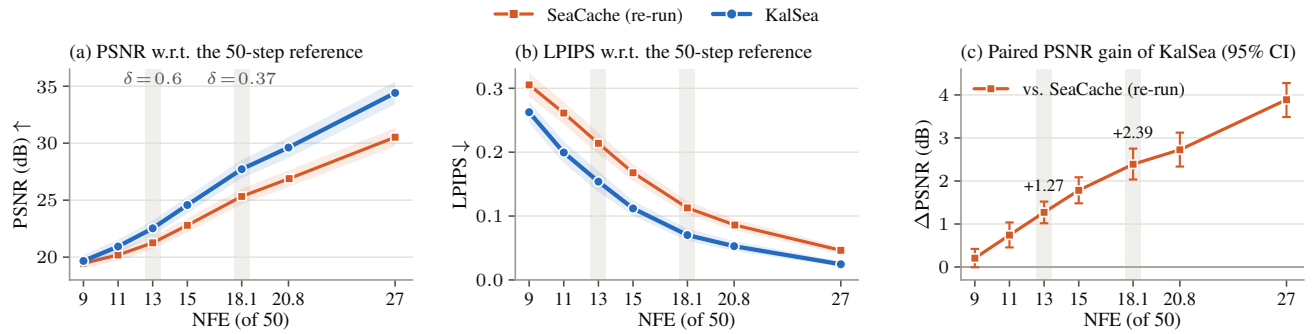


Figure 3. **Fidelity vs. compute on FLUX.1-dev** (DrawBench, 200 held-out prompts). **(a)** PSNR and **(b)** LPIPS w.r.t. the 50-step reference vs. the mean number of transformer evaluations per image; the SEA-gate threshold $\delta \in \{0.2, 0.3, 0.37, 0.5, 0.6, 0.8, 1.0\}$, shared by all methods, sets the budget, and gray bands mark the budgets of Tab. 1. All methods share code, seeds and hardware (SeaCache: our re-run of its released gate with reuse). Lines: means over prompts; shaded: 95% bootstrap CIs. **(c)** Paired PSNR gain of KalSea (95% CIs): over SeaCache, it grows from +0.21 dB [−0.005, +0.42] at 9 NFE (not significant) to +3.89 dB [+3.49, +4.28] at 27 NFE.

Algorithm 1 KalSea sampling. The second **if** block is PCGS; without it, the procedure is the predictor alone (KalSea w/o PCGS).

Require: noise $\mathbf{x}_0$, schedule $\sigma_0 > \cdots > \sigma_N = 0$, threshold δ
$D \leftarrow 0$; gap $\mathcal{S} \leftarrow \emptyset$
for $i = 0, \ldots, N-1$ **do**
  $\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}} \leftarrow \text{Emb}(\mathbf{x}_i)$; $D \leftarrow D + d_i$; predict ▷ (3), (4)
  if $i \in \{0, N-1\}$ **or** $D \geq \delta$ **then** ▷ computed step, $b = i$
    $\mathbf{r}_i \leftarrow \mathcal{F}(\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}}) - \mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}}$; $D \leftarrow 0$; Kalman update ▷ (5)
    $\mathbf{v}_i \leftarrow \text{Out}(\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}} + \mathbf{r}_i, \mathbf{c}_i)$
  else ▷ skipped step
    $\hat{\mathbf{r}}_i \leftarrow m_i^-$; $\mathbf{v}_i \leftarrow \text{Out}(\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}} + \hat{\mathbf{r}}_i, \mathbf{c}_i)$; $\mathcal{S} \leftarrow \mathcal{S} \cup \{i\}$
  if step i was computed **and** $\mathcal{S} \neq \emptyset$ **then**
    $\tilde{\mathbf{r}}_j \leftarrow \hat{\mathbf{r}}_j + \mathcal{G}_j(\mathbf{r}_i - \hat{\mathbf{r}}_i)$, $j \in \mathcal{S}$ ▷ (7)
    $\mathbf{x}' \leftarrow \mathbf{x}_{\min \mathcal{S}}$ ▷ (8)
    for $j \in \mathcal{S}$ in ascending order **do**
      $\mathbf{x}' \leftarrow \mathbf{x}' + (\sigma_{j+1} - \sigma_j)\ \text{Out}(\text{Emb}(\mathbf{x}') + \tilde{\mathbf{r}}_j, \mathbf{c}_j)$
    $\mathbf{v}_i \leftarrow \text{Out}(\text{Emb}(\mathbf{x}') + \mathbf{r}_i, \mathbf{c}_i) + \frac{\mathbf{x}' - \mathbf{x}_i}{\sigma_{i+1} - \sigma_i}$ ▷ (9)
    recompute the gate reference from $\mathbf{x}'$; $\mathcal{S} \leftarrow \emptyset$
  $\mathbf{x}_{i+1} \leftarrow \mathbf{x}_i + (\sigma_{i+1} - \sigma_i)\, \mathbf{v}_i$ ▷ unchanged sampler
return $\mathbf{x}_N$

flow-matching schedule, embedded guidance 3.5, and the 200 DrawBench prompts [37]; the seed of each image is its prompt index. For text-to-video generation we use HunyuanVideo [17] at 480×640 and Wan2.1-T2V-1.3B [47] at 832×480, both with 65 frames, 50 steps and seed 42, on the 944 unique VBench prompts [13]. All methods share the seeds, and each accelerated sample is compared with the output of the uncached 50-step sampler for the same prompt and seed.

Budgets and baselines. We report the mean number of block-stack evaluations per image (NFE, of 50), counted by hooks on every block, and compare only at matched NFE. Tab. 1 lists the results that SeaCache published for itself, TeaCache, TaylorSeer, Δ-DiT, ToCa and fewer steps [7], with TFLOPs converted to NFE. Our caches use the official SEA gate, whose threshold δ sets the budget. At $\delta = 0.6$ it computes 13.0 steps both in SeaCache's table and in our setup, where our re-run of SeaCache reproduces the published PSNR (21.26 vs. 21.33 dB); at $\delta = 0.3$ it computes 20.9 steps in our setup but 18.4 according to the TFLOPs, so we run our cache at $\delta = 0.37$ (18.1 NFE) and 0.6. For

Table 1. **Text-to-image results on FLUX.1-dev** (DrawBench, 200 held-out prompts). †Published by SeaCache [7] (its Table 1; other hardware; seeds and metric code not stated); NFE = 50 × TFLOPs/2976, a FLOP equivalent for Δ-DiT and ToCa. ‡The two rows appear swapped there. SeaCache's released gate computes 20.9 steps at δ=0.3 in our setup, not 18.4, so we match NFE rather than δ (δ=0.3: Tab. 3, supplement). Lat.: s/image; –: not yet measured.

Method	NFE	TFLOPs	Lat.	PSNR↑	SSIM↑	LPIPS↓
Original (50 steps)	50	–	–	–	–	–
≈ 18 NFE (baselines: 18–33 NFE)						
Δ-DiT [5]†	33.3	–	–	17.40	0.710	0.336
TeaCache [21] (δ=0.3)†	26.0	–	–	20.76	0.810	0.211
Vanilla, 25 steps†‡	25.0	–	–	15.55	0.668	0.409
ToCa [55]†	21.2	–	–	18.40	0.700	0.324
TaylorSeer [22] (S=3)†	20.0	–	–	22.78	0.828	0.163
SeaCache [7] (δ=0.3)†	18.4	–	–	26.29	0.893	0.106
KalSea (δ=0.37)	18.1	–	–	**27.72**	**0.916**	**0.070**
13 NFE (baselines: 13–15 NFE)						
TeaCache [21] (δ=0.6)†	15.0	–	–	17.21	0.714	0.348
Vanilla, 15 steps†‡	15.0	–	–	17.84	0.740	0.305
TaylorSeer [22] (S=5)†	14.0	–	–	19.97	0.762	0.236
SeaCache [7] (δ=0.6)†	13.0	–	–	21.33	0.798	0.226
KalSea (δ=0.6)	13.0	–	–	**22.53**	**0.842**	**0.154**

Table 2. **Text-to-video results** (944 VBench prompts, 65 frames, fidelity to the 50-step output). †Published by SeaCache [7] (its Tables 3 and 4; other GPUs, seed not stated; its Wan2.1 compute corresponds to 81 frames), NFE $= 50 \times$ TFLOPs/TFLOPs of the full run. §Our re-run of SeaCache's released code with the corrected gate (same code, seeds and GPUs as KalSea); published: 32.39 dB at 24.0 NFE and 26.46 dB at 16.4 NFE, the latter not reproducible with the released code (its gate gives 20.52 dB at 16.0 NFE). Thresholds and strides of all rows: supplement. –: not yet measured.

	HunyuanVideo, 480×640, 65 frames						Wan2.1 1.3B, 832×480, 65 frames					
Method	NFE	TFLOPs	Lat. (s)	PSNR↑	SSIM↑	LPIPS↓	NFE	TFLOPs	Lat. (s)	PSNR↑	SSIM↑	LPIPS↓
Reference (50 steps)	50	–	–	–	–	–	50	–	–	–	–	–
≈ 50% budget (24–26 NFE)												
Fewer steps†	25.0	–	–	19.97	0.731	0.263	–	–	–	–	–	–
TeaCache [21]†	24.9	–	–	23.40	0.805	0.133	25.0	–	–	20.84	0.721	0.171
TaylorSeer [22]†	26.0	–	–	24.14	0.820	0.152	25.5	–	–	16.15	0.543	0.336
SeaCache [7]	24.0§	–	–	32.43	0.929	0.048	24.0†	–	–	26.60	0.873	0.075
KalSea	24.0	–	–	**35.60**	**0.951**	**0.028**	24.0	–	–	**31.67**	**0.953**	**0.020**
≈ 30% budget (15–18 NFE)												
Fewer steps†	15.0	–	–	17.49	0.662	0.371	–	–	–	–	–	–
TeaCache [21]†	17.1	–	–	20.42	0.734	0.172	18.0	–	–	18.88	0.645	0.245
TaylorSeer [22]†	18.0	–	–	20.42	0.733	0.242	18.0	–	–	14.18	0.453	0.455
SeaCache [7]	16.0§	–	–	24.53	0.813	0.155	17.0†	–	–	21.78	0.740	0.170
KalSea	16.0	–	–	**26.45**	**0.846**	**0.117**	17.0	–	–	**23.85**	**0.851**	**0.090**

controlled comparisons (same code, seeds and hardware), four fillers run behind the same gate: reuse (SeaCache), linear extrapolation of the residual from the last two computed steps (the first-order forecast of TaylorSeer [22]), the Kalman forecast (KalSea w/o PCGS), and KalSea. Behind the same gate, the caches compute the same steps on most prompts (supplement).

Metrics. PSNR on 8-bit RGB, SSIM [49] (scikit-image, 7×7 window) and LPIPS (AlexNet features [51]) are computed against the 50-step reference and averaged over prompts. Differences between methods run in the same setup come with paired bootstrap 95% confidence intervals over prompts (10,000 resamples, percentile) and the fraction of prompts on which a method is better.

Development and test prompts. All design decisions (the smoother, the re-integration and continuation rules, τ and R) were made on a development set of 64 COCO captions [19], and the forecaster was calibrated on 16 other COCO captions. DrawBench was only used to score finished configurations and is thus a held-out test set (development-set results: supplement).

Implementation. For FLUX.1-dev, our cache replaces the forward pass of the transformer in diffusers; the scheduler is unchanged, and the re-integration (8) reproduces its arithmetic. All runs use bf16 on NVIDIA B200 GPUs. For video we use the calibration-free per-element filter, since the DCT bands are defined on 2D token grids.

4.2. Comparison at matched NFE

Tab. 1 compares KalSea with published results. At 18.1 NFE, KalSea reaches 27.72 dB PSNR, 1.43 dB above the 26.29 dB reported for SeaCache at 18.4 NFE, with better SSIM and LPIPS, and it exceeds all baselines that use more evaluations. At 13 NFE, it reaches 22.53 vs. 21.33 dB, again with better SSIM and LPIPS. In our same-setup runs, KalSea improves over SeaCache by 2.39 dB [2.03, 2.75] (better on 88% of the prompts) at 18.1 NFE and by 1.27 dB [1.02, 1.52] (79%) at 13 NFE.

Budget sweep. Fig. 3 varies δ from 0.2 to 1.0 in the same setup. KalSea attains the highest PSNR and the lowest LPIPS at every budget; its PSNR gain over our re-run of SeaCache grows from 0.74 dB [0.46, 1.04] at 11 NFE to 3.89 dB [3.49, 4.28] at 27 NFE, and at 9 NFE only LPIPS improves significantly (0.043 [0.033, 0.053]).

Qualitative results. The supplement compares images of prompts selected by a fixed rule; Fig. 1 shows images generated by KalSea at 27 NFE.

4.3. Video generation

We apply our cache with the per-element filter to HunyuanVideo and Wan2.1-1.3B at SeaCache's two budgets (Tab. 2); on Wan2.1 (UniPC, classifier-free guidance) PCGS replays the solver (Sec. 3.3). SeaCache's released HunyuanVideo script binds its gate to a scheduler that the pipeline replaces at inference, so the SEA filter sees a noise level near one at every step and skips step 1 once $\delta \gtrsim 0.21$; prompts that skip it score 12–14 dB lower (supplement). We let every

Table 3. **Ablations** (FLUX.1-dev, DrawBench-200, held out). First row: PSNR of KalSea; other rows: paired PSNR difference to KalSea (dB, 95% bootstrap CI). All rows share the SEA gate and threshold, with NFE within 0.06 (0.00) of KalSea at δ=0.3 (0.6). All metrics: supplement.

Variant	20.8 NFE (δ=0.3)	13 NFE (δ=0.6)
KalSea (Kalman + PCGS)	29.62 dB	22.53 dB
(a) Filler on skipped steps, no correction		
Reuse (SeaCache)	−2.73 [−3.12, −2.34]	−1.27 [−1.52, −1.02]
Linear extrapolation	−1.11 [−1.34, −0.89]	−0.73 [−0.92, −0.54]
Kalman (KalSea w/o PCGS)	−0.83 [−1.02, −0.63]	−0.61 [−0.76, −0.48]
(b) Correction of the Kalman forecast		
Filter state only	−0.86 [−1.06, −0.68]	−0.63 [−0.78, −0.50]
Linear interpolation	+0.14 [+0.04, +0.25]	+0.00 [−0.05, +0.06]
Forecast + lin. innov.	+0.14 [+0.04, +0.25]	+0.02 [−0.03, +0.07]
Batched re-integration	−0.22 [−0.34, −0.09]	−0.06 [−0.13, +0.01]
No gate refresh	+0.03 [−0.04, +0.10]	+0.01 [−0.01, +0.03]
(c) Other forecaster, with PCGS		
Per-element filter	+0.01 [−0.15, +0.14]	−0.01 [−0.15, +0.13]
Damping τ=0.1	−0.08 [−0.29, +0.12]	+0.05 [−0.11, +0.22]
Calibration-free	−0.02 [−0.11, +0.08]	+0.02 [−0.13, +0.17]
(d) PCGS on other fillers		
Reuse + PCGS	−1.03 [−1.39, −0.67]	−0.53 [−0.76, −0.29]
Linear extrap. + PCGS	+0.04 [−0.08, +0.16]	+0.07 [−0.05, +0.18]

gated method read the sampler's noise level and set δ for 24.0 and 16.0 NFE. Our re-run of SeaCache then reproduces its published result at 24 NFE (32.43 vs. 32.39 dB) but not at 16.4 (24.53 dB at 16.0 vs. 26.46 dB; its released gate gives 20.52 dB), so Tab. 2 reports the re-run for HunyuanVideo. There, KalSea improves on SeaCache by 3.17 dB [2.99, 3.35] at 24 NFE and by 1.92 dB [1.70, 2.14] at 16 NFE (better on 90% and 72% of the prompts), with better SSIM and LPIPS. On Wan2.1 it exceeds SeaCache's published results by 5.07 and 2.07 dB at 24 and 17 NFE. In our setup the paired gains are 2.27 dB [2.13, 2.42] and 0.33 dB [0.16, 0.49], the latter with clearly better SSIM (+0.023) and LPIPS (−0.029); part of the distance to the published Wan2.1 numbers thus comes from the setup (our clips have 65 frames).

4.4. Ablations

Anatomy of the corrector. Tab. 3 reports paired PSNR differences to KalSea at $\delta = 0.3$ (20.8 NFE) and 0.6; differences below 0.1 dB are within run-to-run noise (a second run of KalSea differs by at most 0.04 dB, as the filter's band statistics use atomic GPU additions). Without PCGS, PSNR drops by 0.83 and 0.61 dB (Kalman row); across budgets, the predictor alone loses its advantage over reuse as gaps grow, while PCGS improves on it at every budget (supplement). The gain comes from re-integrating the latent: feeding the smoothed residuals only into the filter state is no better than no correction (−0.86 vs. −0.83 dB at 20.8 NFE). The shape of the gains matters little: a linear interpolation from $\mathbf{r}_a$ to $\mathbf{r}_b$ and the forecast plus a linearly weighted innovation match the RTS gains at 13 NFE and exceed them by 0.14 dB [0.04, 0.25] at 20.8 NFE; we keep the RTS gains chosen on the development set (supplement). The batched re-integration on the stored inputs $\mathbf{h}_i^{\text{in}}$ loses 0.22 dB [0.09, 0.34] at 20.8 NFE, and the gate refresh has no measurable effect.

Other forecasters and fillers. With PCGS, the forecaster's parametrization hardly matters: the per-element filter, the damping $\tau = 0.1$ of SpecKCast and a calibration-free filter all stay within 0.1 dB of KalSea, so the frequency decomposition is unnecessary for the residual and we use the per-element filter for video. Nor is PCGS tied to a Kalman forecaster: it improves reuse by 1.69 and 0.74 dB and linear extrapolation by 1.15 and 0.80 dB (supplement); linear extrapolation with PCGS then ties KalSea, while reuse with PCGS stays 1.03 and 0.53 dB below. Forecasting a sampler quantity (clean image, noise or velocity) instead of the residual is not better (supplement).

5. Conclusion

Caching fillers for diffusion transformers are open loop. PCGS closes this loop at no cost in network evaluations: once the next step is computed, it estimates the residuals of the skipped gap with the RTS smoother of the forecaster's own state-space model and re-integrates the gap through the output layers. With the SEA gate and a Kalman residual forecaster, it improves fidelity to the 50-step sampler at every budget we tested on FLUX.1-dev, and the gains carry over to HunyuanVideo and Wan2.1. The benefit lies in the re-integration itself: a linear interpolation across the gap works as well as the RTS gains, and the correction also repairs reuse and linear extrapolation. Promising directions are to choose the computed steps jointly with the corrector and to correct caches that operate on features inside the block stack.

Limitations. Matched NFE is not matched latency: PCGS adds output-layer evaluations (about 0.3% of one transformer evaluation per image) and 0.02 GiB of memory over KalSea w/o PCGS, and the filter adds elementwise work on every step. Our metrics measure fidelity to the 50-step sampler, the goal of a cache, not sample quality. Our image results cover a single model. On Wan2.1, the same-setup PSNR gain is only 0.33 dB at 17 NFE and negative at 10 NFE on 20 prompts (supplement). At a computed step, PCGS attaches the residual evaluated at the uncorrected latent to the corrected one, an approximation that is accurate only for small corrections; at the smallest budget, with gaps of up to twelve steps, its gain is modest (0.31 dB at 9 NFE).

LLM Usage Statement

LLM-based assistants were used in this work to propose and implement method variants and experiment code, to run

and monitor experiments and evaluation scripts, to draft and edit text and figures, and to check the reported numbers against the logged results. The authors directed the research and take full responsibility for the content of this paper.

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